



Providing Fair & Developmental Reviews

May, 2025 – Monthly Manager Meeting

Welcome

Objectives:

- Understand what makes feedback fair and developmental.
- Practice reviewing and improving written feedback.
- Leave with tools to support the annual review process.



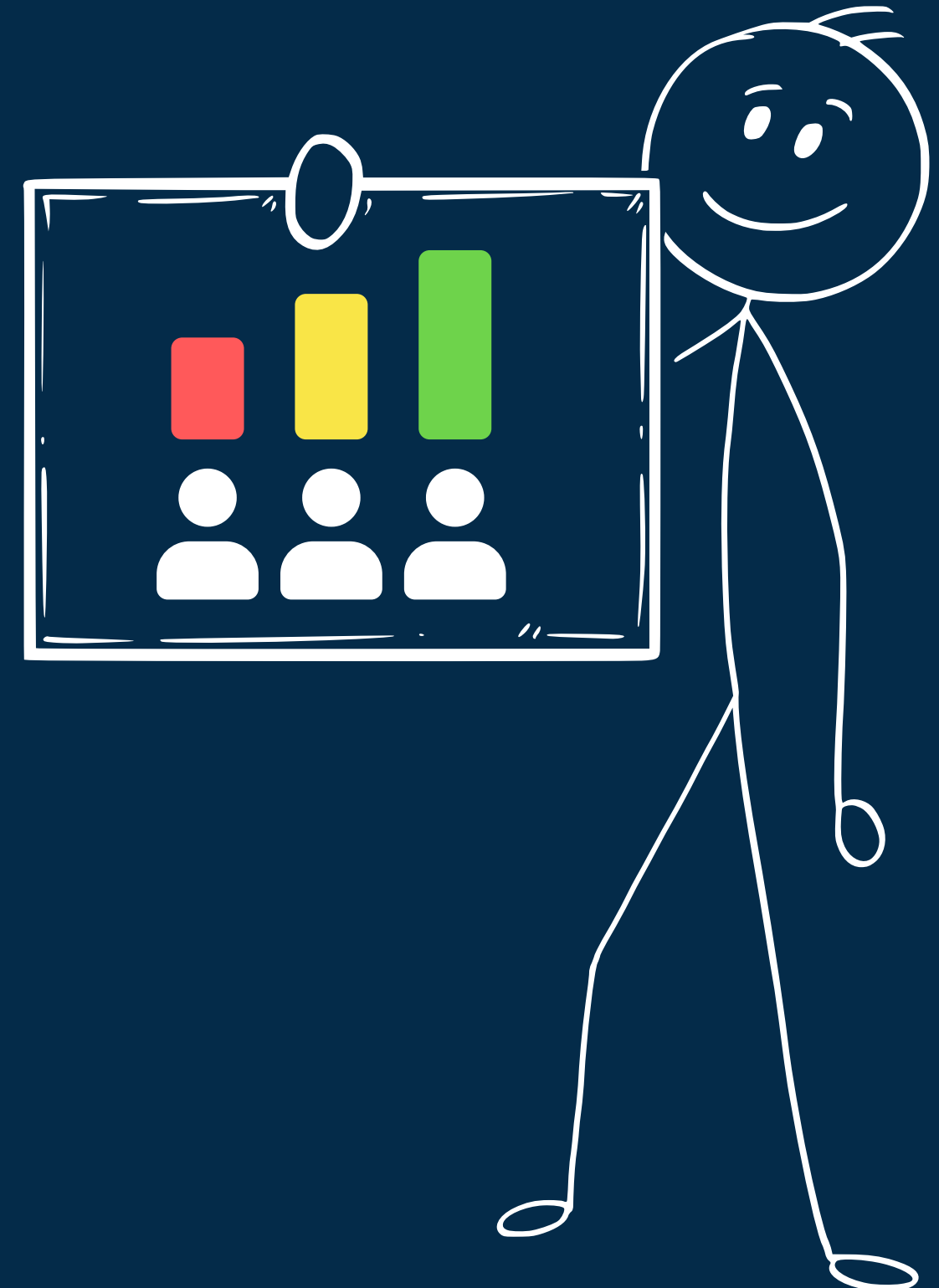
Agenda:

- ✓ Welcome/Framing (5 min)
- ✓ Why It Matters (10 min)
- ✓ Mini-Lesson: What Makes a Review “Fair & Developmental”? (10 min)
- ✓ Practice (20 min)
- ✓ Share Out (10 min)
- ✓ Close/Next Steps (5 min)



Quick–Check (Poll)

How confident do you feel
writing performance
reviews?" (Scale 1–5)



Why This Matters



Clear feedback supports growth and retention

Reviews are a tool for development, not just documentation

Aligns with our values of equity, transparency, and care

Think-Pair-Share Prompt

"What's one time you received a piece of feedback that really helped you grow?"

"What made it effective?"



What Makes Feedback Fair?



Rooted in observable behavior and impact
(**SBI Approach** – Situation, Behavior, Impact)

Avoids assumptions and personality judgments

Free from bias (recency, halo/horns, similarity, etc.)

What Makes Feedback Developmental?

1

Clear on strengths and growth areas

2

Uses specific examples and data

3

Focused on improvement, not perfection



Example Language Starters

"One way you've consistently contributed is..."

"A growth area to continue working on is..."

"A specific example that illustrates this is..."

Break-out Practice Instructions

Break into groups

Read the sample review

Edit for fairness and development

Share a review draft with a peer for feedback (Optional)



Practice Examples:

Competency: Communication



Weak Review Sample:

"Jordan communicates pretty well with the team. Everyone seems to like working with them."



Why it needs improvement:

Vague and subjective; lacks evidence and growth-focused insight.



Revised Review:

"Jordan consistently shares project updates in a timely and accessible manner through weekly Slack check-ins and follow-up emails. One opportunity for growth is to ensure clarity when outlining next steps in team meetings, which can occasionally lead to confusion."



Practice Examples:

Competency: Collaboration



Weak Review Sample:

"Nia is a great team player and gets along with everyone."



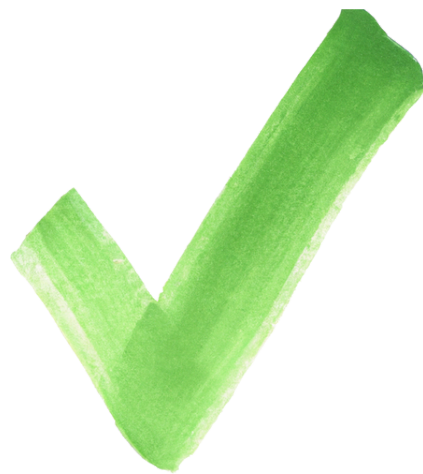
Why it needs improvement:

Generic praise; doesn't highlight impact or specific behaviors.



Revised Review:

"Nia regularly collaborates cross-functionally, as seen in her recent partnership with the IT team to streamline the onboarding toolkit. Her proactive check-ins and solution-oriented mindset have helped reduce delays. One area for development is balancing collaboration with prioritizing independent project tasks."



Practice Examples:

Competency: Initiative



Weak Review Sample:

"Luis is super driven. He works hard and tries to do his best."



Why it needs improvement:

Too general and evaluative;
lacks context.



Revised Review:

"Luis took initiative in redesigning our internal FAQ page, identifying outdated content and proposing a new layout that increased usability. A potential area for continued growth is aligning proactive efforts with team priorities to avoid duplicative work."



Practice Examples:

Competency: Results Orientation



Weak Review Sample:

"Alyssa always delivers results. She hits her goals every time."



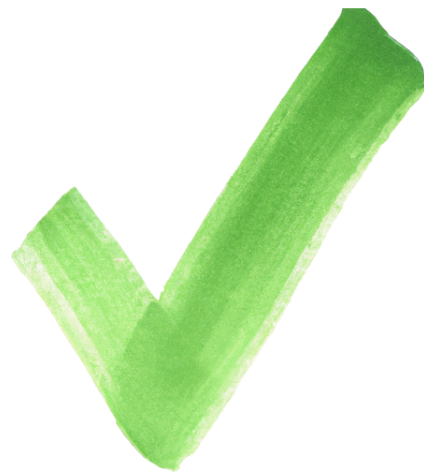
Why it needs improvement:

No concrete examples; lacks nuance.



Revised Review:

"Alyssa has met or exceeded all performance targets this quarter, including achieving a 20% increase in volunteer tutor attendance through her outreach campaigns. To further develop, she could document her workflows so that others can replicate her success."



Practice Examples:

Competency: Adaptability



Weak Review Sample:

"Tony handles change well and doesn't complain."



Why it needs improvement:

Informal tone, lacks depth, and misses opportunity to highlight growth.



Revised Review:

"Tony demonstrated adaptability during the recent CRM system transition by quickly learning the platform and volunteering to support colleagues. As a next step, he might explore documenting best practices to help others adjust even more smoothly in future transitions."



Share Out

- What did you notice?
- What changes did you make?
- How might you apply this to your reviews?



Key Dates Reminder

SAVE THE DATE

4/28 Self-Reviews Due

**5/19-
5/30** 1:1 Conversations

5/9 Manager Reviews Due

**6/2-
6/6** Signature Window

**5/12-
5/18** 2nd Level
Acknowledgements

6/6 Performance Reviews Due



Thank you